全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 37 單元 | 運動與休閒 · Sports & Leisure

More Than a Race: Taiwan's Marathon Fever

不只是比賽：台灣的馬拉松熱

Twenty years ago, running was something most people in Taiwan did only in PE class. Today, on almost every weekend from October to March, thousands of runners gather before dawn for a marathon somewhere on the island. From the Taipei Marathon, which starts outside the city stadium, to small races along the east coast, the sport has become one of the most popular forms of recreation in the country.

What makes these events special is that most competitors are amateurs. A typical race includes a few professional athletes who compete for the title of champion and a medal, but behind them run office workers, grandmothers, students, and sometimes a man dressed as a bubble tea cup. Many of them do not care about their opponents at all. Their only competition is with themselves: to finish, or to run a little faster than last year.

The spectators are part of the show. Along the route, families hand out water and sliced oranges, temple volunteers beat drums, and elementary school children hold signs that say "Keep going, uncle!" In Taitung, where the race passes rice fields and the Pacific Ocean, some runners stop to take photos, as if the event were an adventure rather than a race.

Doctors point out that this kind of outdoor leisure brings more than fitness. Training for a marathon gives people a goal, a reason to sleep early, and a group of friends who share the same early-morning suffering. "Running is my relaxation," says a 52-year-old climber and hiker from Hualien who finished her tenth marathon last winter. "For four hours, nobody can call me about work." For a growing number of people, that may be the best prize of all.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
marathon	*n.*	馬拉松	My uncle finished his first marathon in five hours. 我叔叔花五小時跑完他的第一場馬拉松。
stadium	*n.*	體育場	The new stadium can hold forty thousand fans. 新體育場可以容納四萬名球迷。

recreation	*n.*	休閒活動；娛樂	The park offers many kinds of recreation for families. 這座公園為家庭提供許多種休閒活動。
competitor	*n.*	參賽者；競爭者	Over a thousand competitors joined the swimming race. 一千多名參賽者參加了游泳比賽。
amateur	*n.*	業餘愛好者	The photo contest is open to amateurs only. 這場攝影比賽只開放給業餘愛好者參加。
athlete	*n.*	運動員	The athlete trains six hours a day. 這位運動員每天訓練六小時。
champion	*n.*	冠軍	She became the national table tennis champion at sixteen. 她十六歲就成為全國桌球冠軍。
medal	*n.*	獎牌	Taiwan won two gold medals at the games. 台灣在這次運動會贏得兩面金牌。
opponent	*n.*	對手	He shook hands with his opponent after the match. 比賽後他和對手握手。
spectator	*n.*	觀眾	Thousands of spectators cheered in the rain. 數千名觀眾在雨中歡呼。

片語 Phrases

hand out	分發	Volunteers handed out water to the runners. 志工發水給跑者。
point out	指出	The coach pointed out that rest is as important as training. 教練指出休息和訓練一樣重要。
rather than	而不是	I prefer hiking rather than shopping on weekends. 週末我比較喜歡健行而不是逛街。

文法與句型 Grammar

as if＋S＋were/過去式 V（與現在事實相反的假設）

as if 表示「彷彿」，後面用過去式（be 動詞用 were）表示與事實不符的想像。文中 as if the event were an adventure 表示比賽其實不是冒險，只是看起來像。

He talks as if he were the champion.

他說話的樣子彷彿他是冠軍一樣。

one of the＋最高級＋複數名詞

「最……之一」，最高級後面的名詞要用複數。文中 one of the most popular forms of recreation 表示「最受歡迎的休閒活動之一」。

Jade Mountain is one of the highest mountains in East Asia.

玉山是東亞最高的山之一。

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